

[Summative #4]

[Replace with Name of Summative Text]

Original Work (*Drop photos if you'd rather not type.*)

1984 and "The Lottery" show that when citizens live in a system, the negative effects that it creates become normalized, preventing meaningful resistance and producing complacent citizens.

Systems create complacent citizens because people are conditioned to accept their acts as normal. In 1984 by George Orwell, the Party demonstrates an ideal civilization where the citizens believe the lies that the Party spreads. Winston explains that "Orthodoxy means not thinking—not needing to think. Orthodoxy is unconsciousness"(Orwell 53). This idea of "orthodoxy" shows that systems of control persist not because they are just, but because people are used to seeing these things as normal. Since the people are "not thinking", they don't realize that the things happening around them are unjust. In addition, during a speech against Eurasia, their enemy, the speaker suddenly receives a paper. Without any noticeable changes, he suddenly starts declaring Eastasia as their enemy. "Without words said, a wave of understanding rippled through the crowd"(Orwell 181). When people accept systems without questioning them, they become participants in their own oppression. The quick change in the information that is being spoken, and the "understanding" by the crowd, prove how people are so used to information being modified that they accept it as being normal.

Even when individuals recognize injustice, social pressure and fear prevents meaningful resistance. "The Lottery" by Shirley Jackson shows how pressures created by systems prevent meaningful resistance and even force individuals to betray others in order for them to survive. When Tessie is chosen for the Lottery, she screams "It isn't fair, it isn't right"(Jackson 80), however nobody acknowledges it. This shows how the pressure of themselves being picked encourage individuals to betray others in order to survive within the system, and the citizens in "The Lottery" would rather protect themselves instead of resisting injustice. Systems like these are successful because they coerce people into betraying each other. In addition, when the process of the Lottery becomes delayed, Mr Summers says "All right, folks...Let's finish quickly"(Jackson 75). This shows how the community chooses tradition over empathy for others. Rather than attempting to save Tessie, they instead choose not to resist. Even if it is unfair, a redrawing of the Lottery could mean that they get picked instead.

In conclusion, 1984 and "The Lottery" reveal that totalitarian systems and traditions exist not because they have power, but because its subjects help the system by conforming and sacrificing others in order to save themselves. These idea matters because it shows how a single person cannot spark a revolution, but a group can. If you identify a system that oppresses certain groups or individuals, don't be afraid to speak out. Revolution will never happen if you are too scared to say anything.

One Thing I'm **Proud** Of:

- A high level and complex thesis sentence.

One Thing I Want to **Improve** On:

- Spelling mistakes and grammatical errors.

Revised Work

(Pick 3-4 spots to showcase the original and the revised version. Aim for significant improvement, not just cosmetic improvements like spelling and grammar.)

[1] ORIGINAL: 1984 and "The Lottery" show that when citizens live in a system, the negative effects that it creates become normalized, preventing meaningful resistance and producing complacent citizens. Systems create complacent citizens because people are conditioned to accept their acts as normal.

[1] REVISION: Both George Orwell's *1984* and Shirley Jackson's "The Lottery" demonstrate how institutional systems condition citizens to normalize systemic cruelty, and neutralize dissent in order to facilitate complacency. When oppressive structures successfully dictate the limits of daily life, citizens stop perceiving systemic harms as injustice, instead viewing them as undeniable realities.

[2] ORIGINAL: In addition, during a speech against Eurasia, their enemy, the speaker suddenly receives a paper. Without any noticeable changes, he suddenly starts declaring Eastasia as their enemy. "Without words said, a wave of understanding rippled through the crowd"(Orwell 181).

[2] REVISION: This psychological conditioning is shown during a public rally when a Party orator is handed a slip of paper during a speech. Without interrupting his speech, he instantly shifts the enemy from being Eurasia to Eastasia, a completely different country. Instantly, "a wave of understanding rippled through the crowd"(Orwell 181).

[3] ORIGINAL: When Tessie is chosen for the Lottery, she screams "It isn't fair, it isn't right"(Jackson 80), however nobody acknowledges it. This shows how the pressure of themselves being picked encourage individuals to betray others in order to survive within the system, and the citizens in "The Lottery" would rather protect themselves instead of resisting injustice.

[3] REVISION: When Tessie Hutchinson is selected for sacrifice and desperately protests that "It isn't fair, it isn't right" (Jackson 80), her cries are met with collective silence. This stark lack of acknowledgment exposes how systemic terror weaponizes the survival instinct; rather than

uniting against an arbitrary execution, the villagers actively participate in Tessie's betrayal to guarantee their own immediate safety.

[4] ORIGINAL: These idea matters because it shows how a single person cannot spark a revolution, but a group can. If you identify a system that opresses certain groups or individuals, don't be afraid to speak out. Revolution will never happen if you are too scared to say anything.

[4] REVISION: Ultimately, these texts serve as a critical warning: while systemic oppression thrives on enforced isolation and fear, meaningful resistance demands collective solidarity. True institutional change cannot be sparked in isolation; it requires individuals to break the cycle of complacency, conquer the fear of nonconformity, and actively speak out against systemic injustice before it becomes fully normalized.